ACCOUNT INTELLIGENCE · CLIENT WEB APP

UI audit and pastel redesign

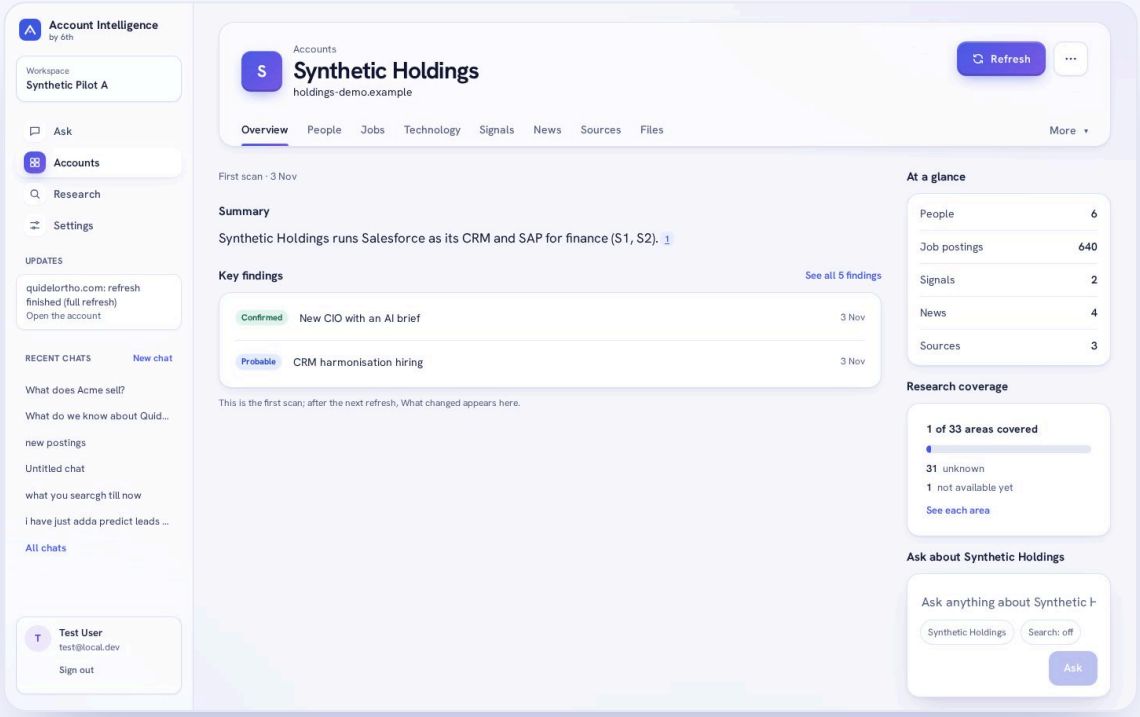
A full audit of the client screens (refresh, pop-ups, buttons, errors and clutter) and a professional pastel look with depth, glow on the next step and feedback on every click. The admin console is unchanged, as asked.

44
problems found

42
fixed or removed

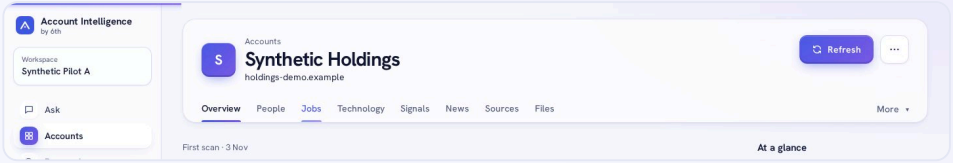
2
kept on purpose or open

21
client screens checked

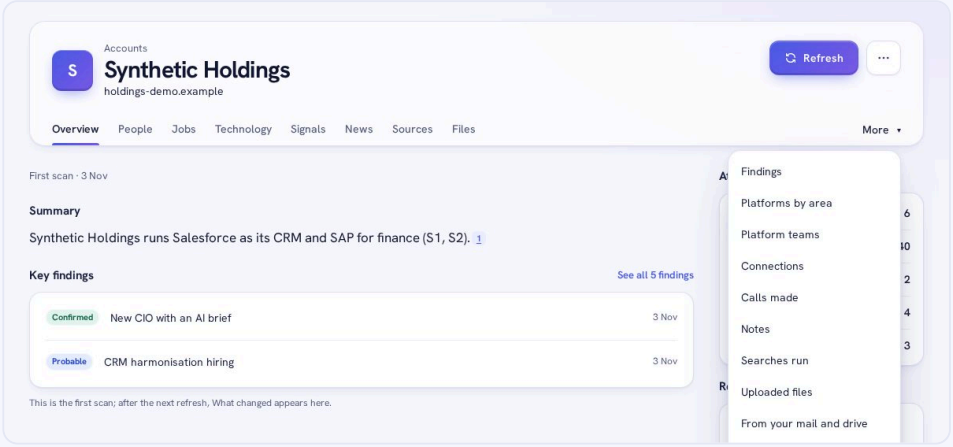


What changed in the look

- **Pastel palette.** White and soft periwinkle surfaces over a faint lavender, blue and mint wash. Mint, butter and rose are kept for status only.
- **Depth, not decoration.** Cards, the sidebar and the account header are raised with layered soft shadows and a thin top highlight. Nothing new was added to the screens.
- **One main button per screen.** Periwinkle-to-lavender gradient with a soft glow. The next step (Ask, Start research, Yes, start) breathes a gentle glow so the eye finds it.
- **Every click answers.** Buttons press in and change colour; a thin glowing bar runs across the top while the next page loads; the tab or link you clicked shows it is opening; a button that is working shows a small spinner.
- **Pop-ups that behave.** One shared pop-up: opens with a short scale-in, keeps keyboard focus inside, closes on Escape or a backdrop click, returns focus, and cannot close while a paid start is being sent.
- **Short notes after actions.** "Refresh started", "Chat deleted", "Auto refresh saved" appear briefly at the bottom and are read out by screen readers.
- **Motion stays light.** Only opacity and transform are animated; everything stops for people who ask their system for reduced motion.



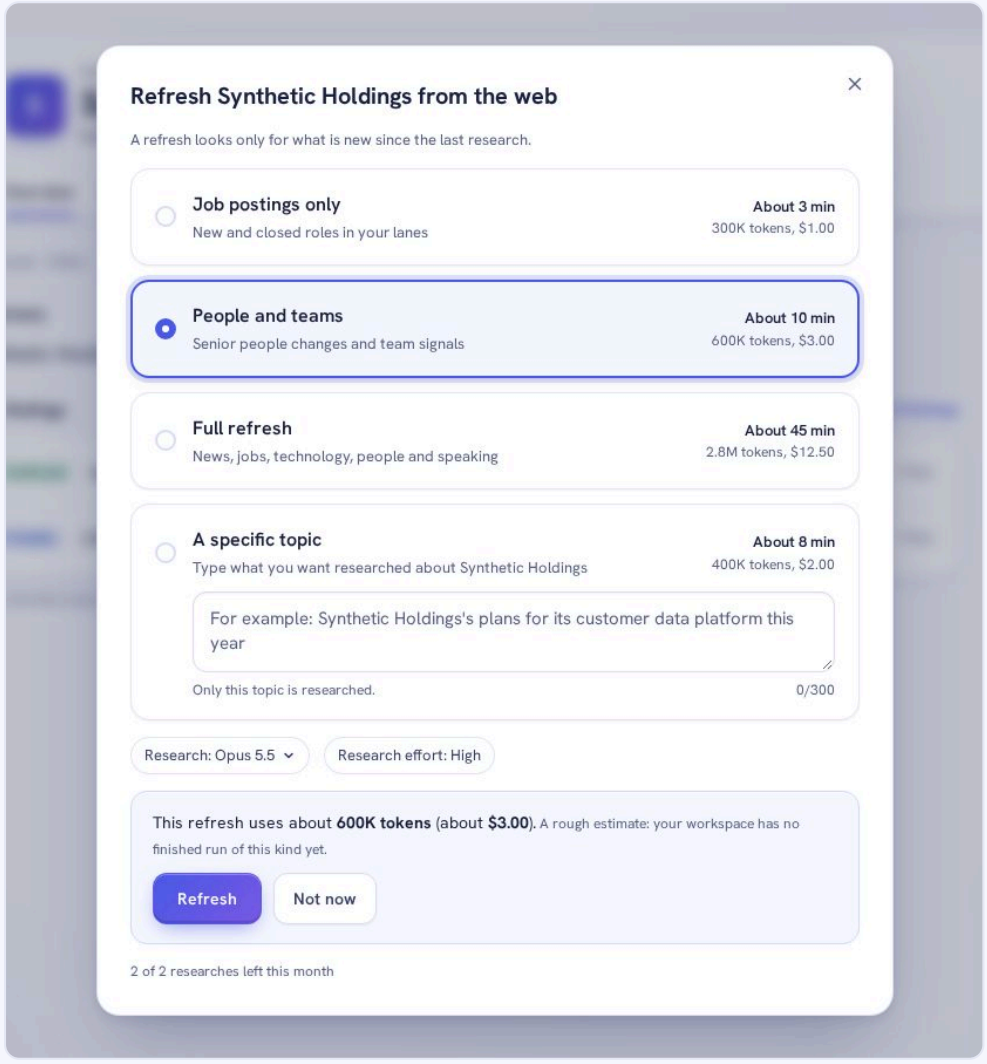
Click feedback: the top bar and the pending tab, 70 ms after a click.



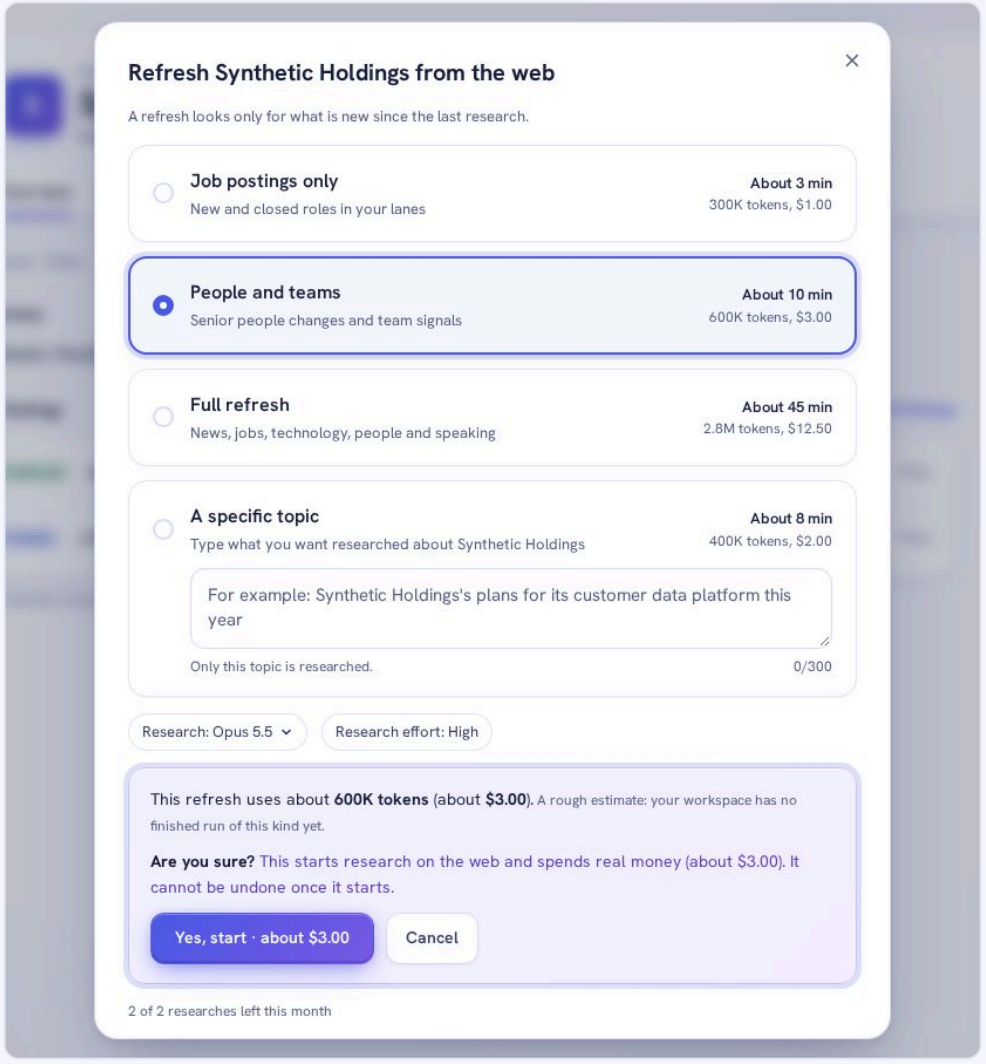
The More menu: it names the open page, closes on Escape, an outside click or a page change.

Spending money: two presses, no extra screens

The owner's rule stays: every research, refresh and file analysis is confirmed twice before money is spent, and the server still refuses a start without both. What changed is how it feels: the cost is shown up front, the first press arms the button (it glows and asks "Are you sure?"), the second press starts. Before, it took three presses across three different screens of text.

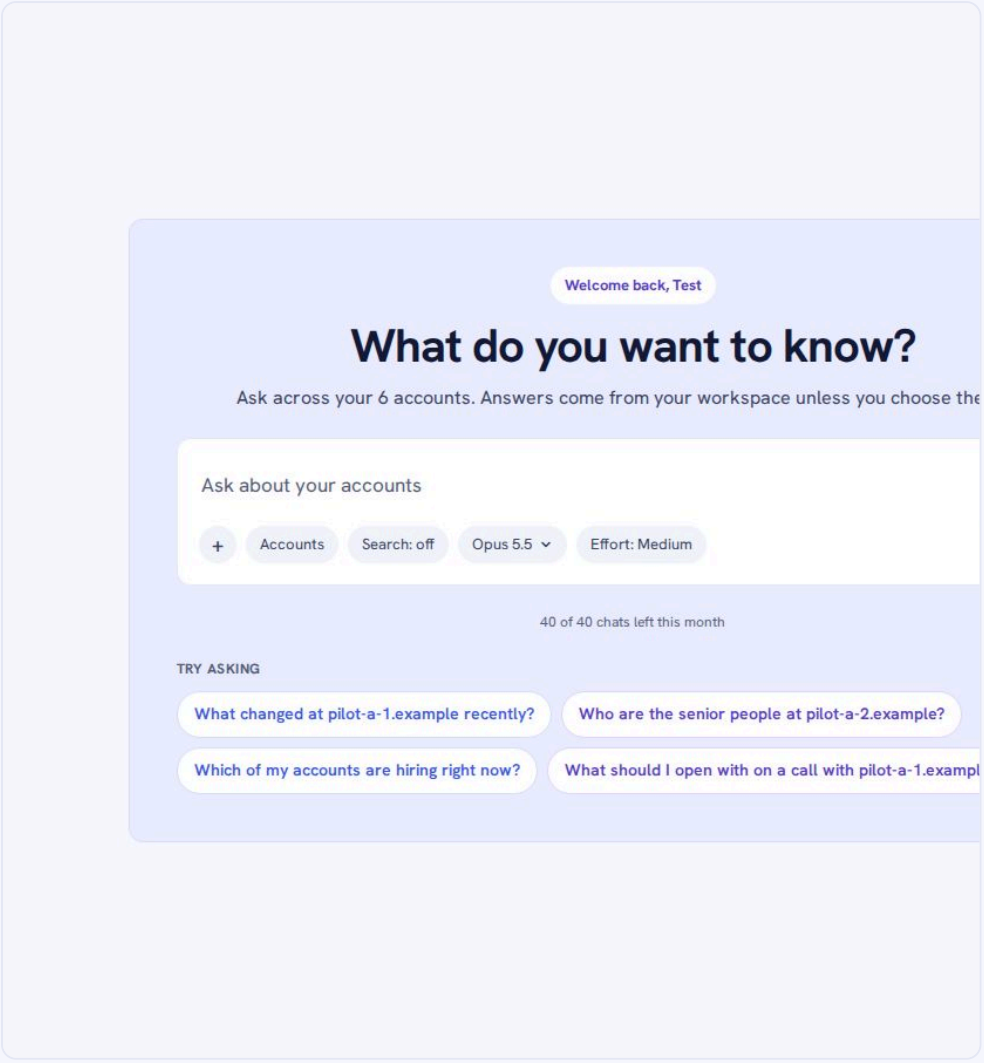


Refresh pop-up: cost of the picked option above one button.

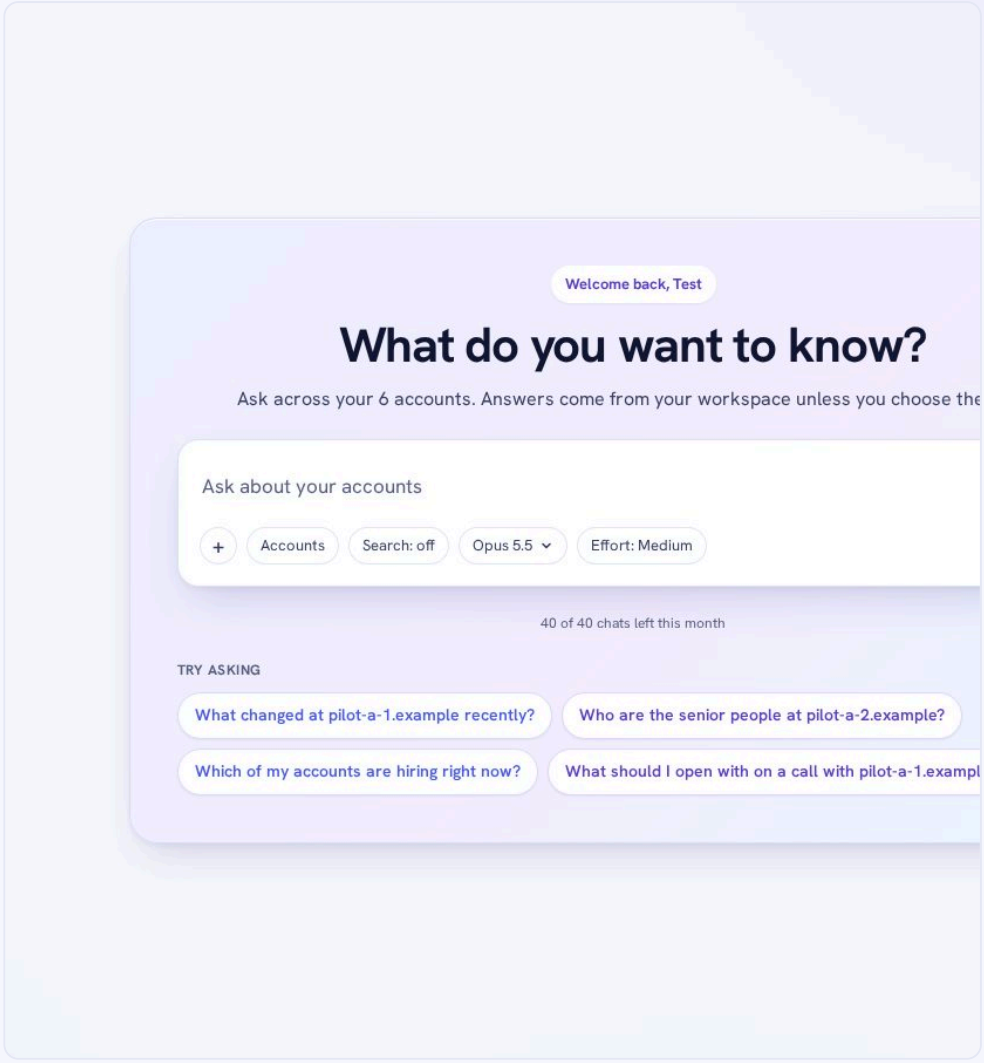


After the first press: "Are you sure?" and the glowing Yes.

Before and after: Ask

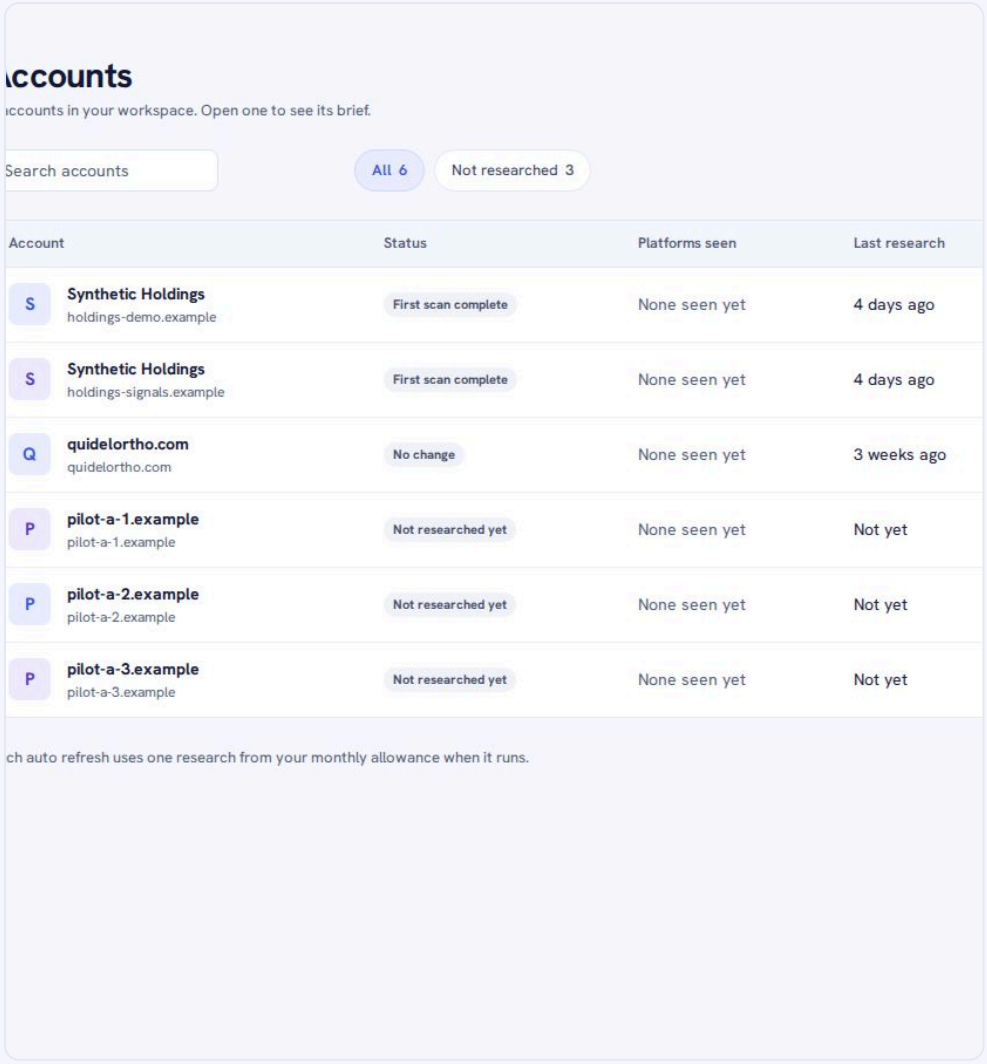


Before

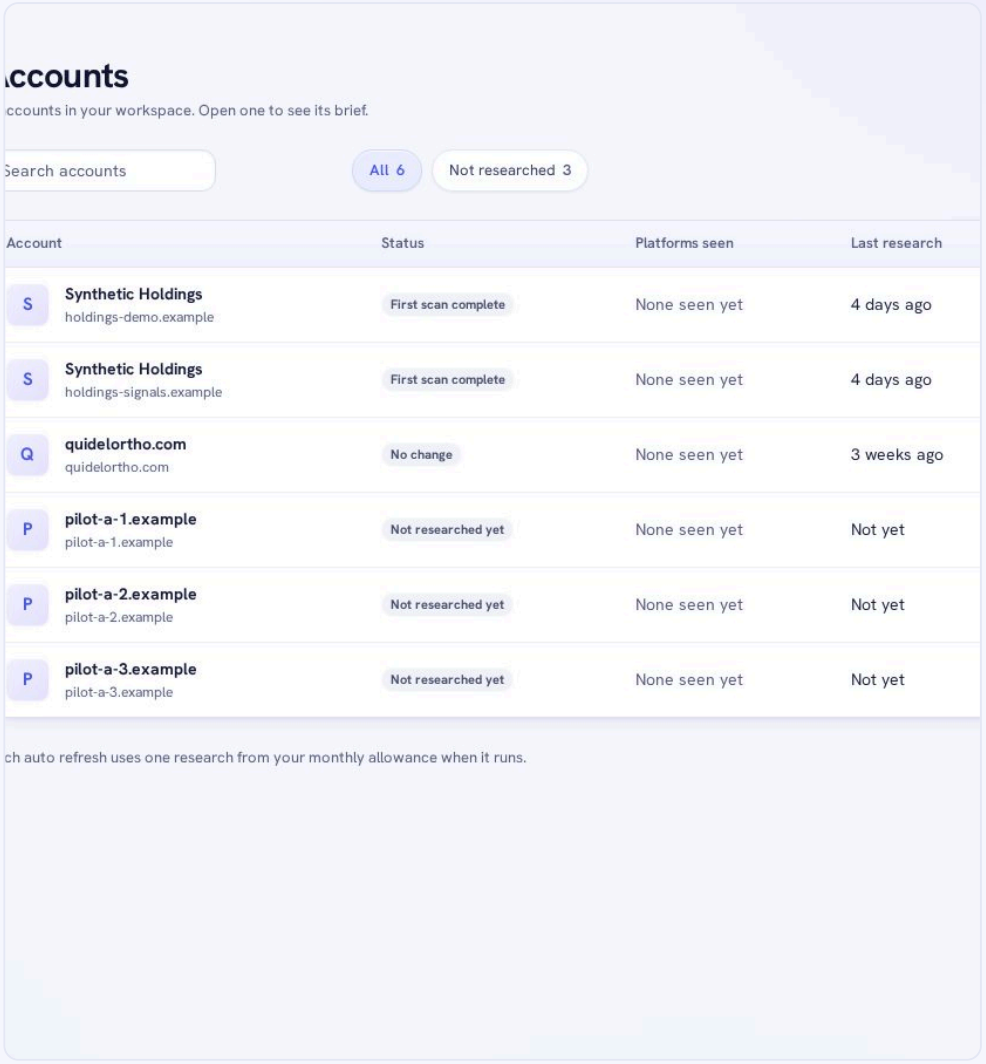


After

Before and after: Accounts

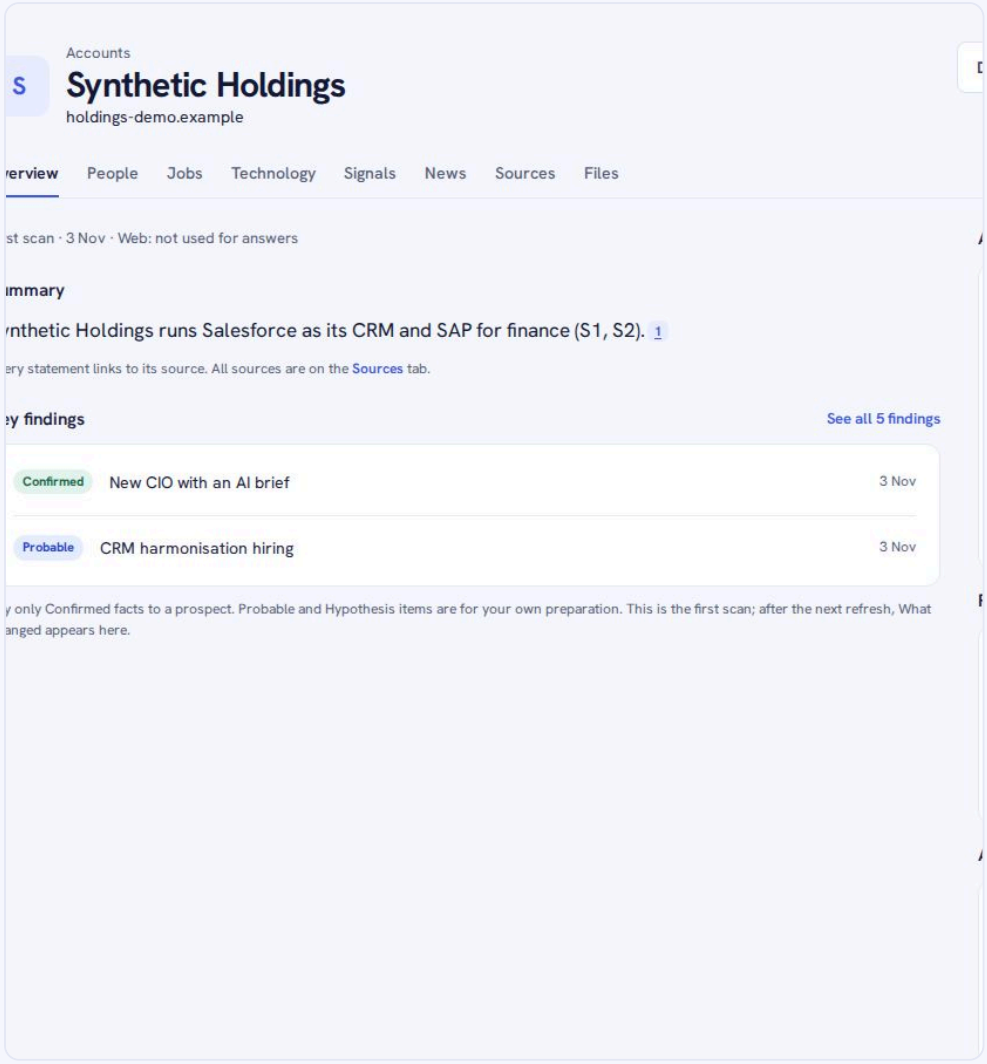


Before

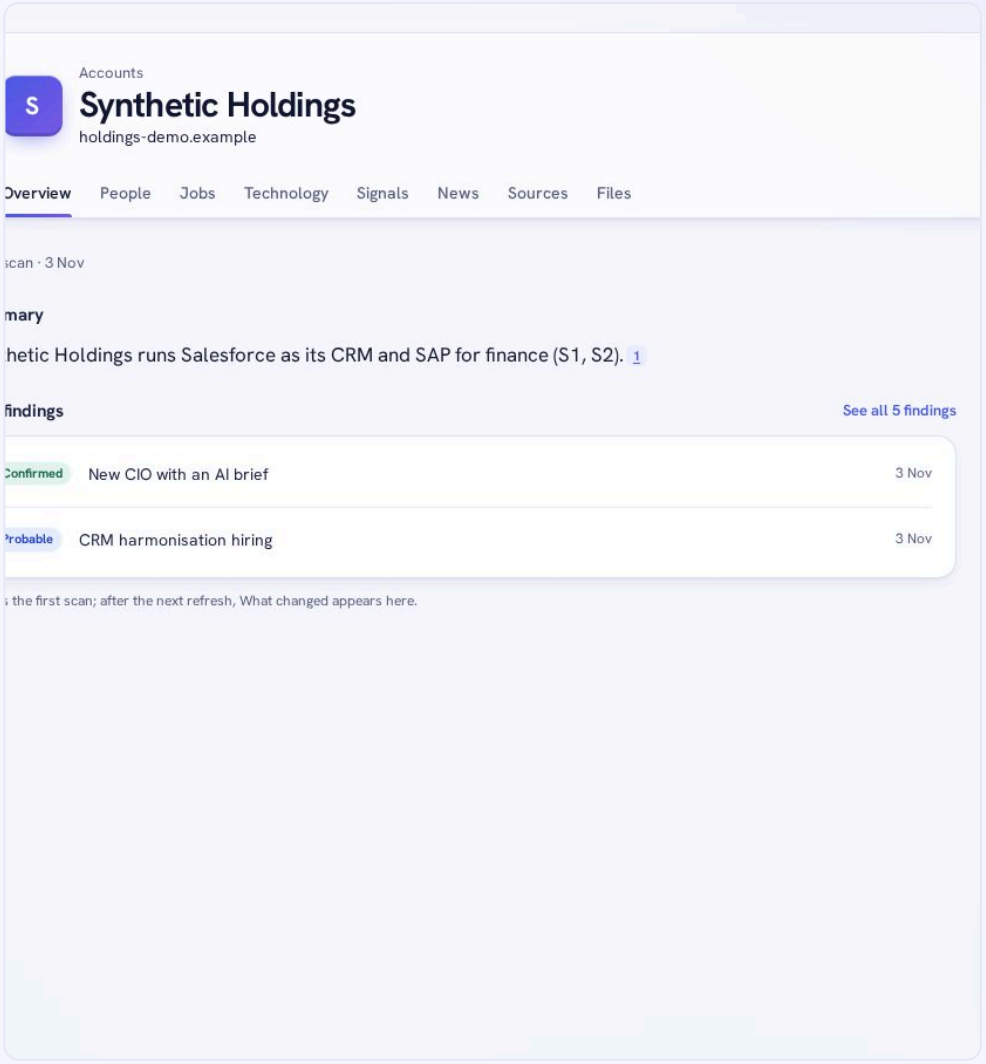


After

Before and after: Account overview

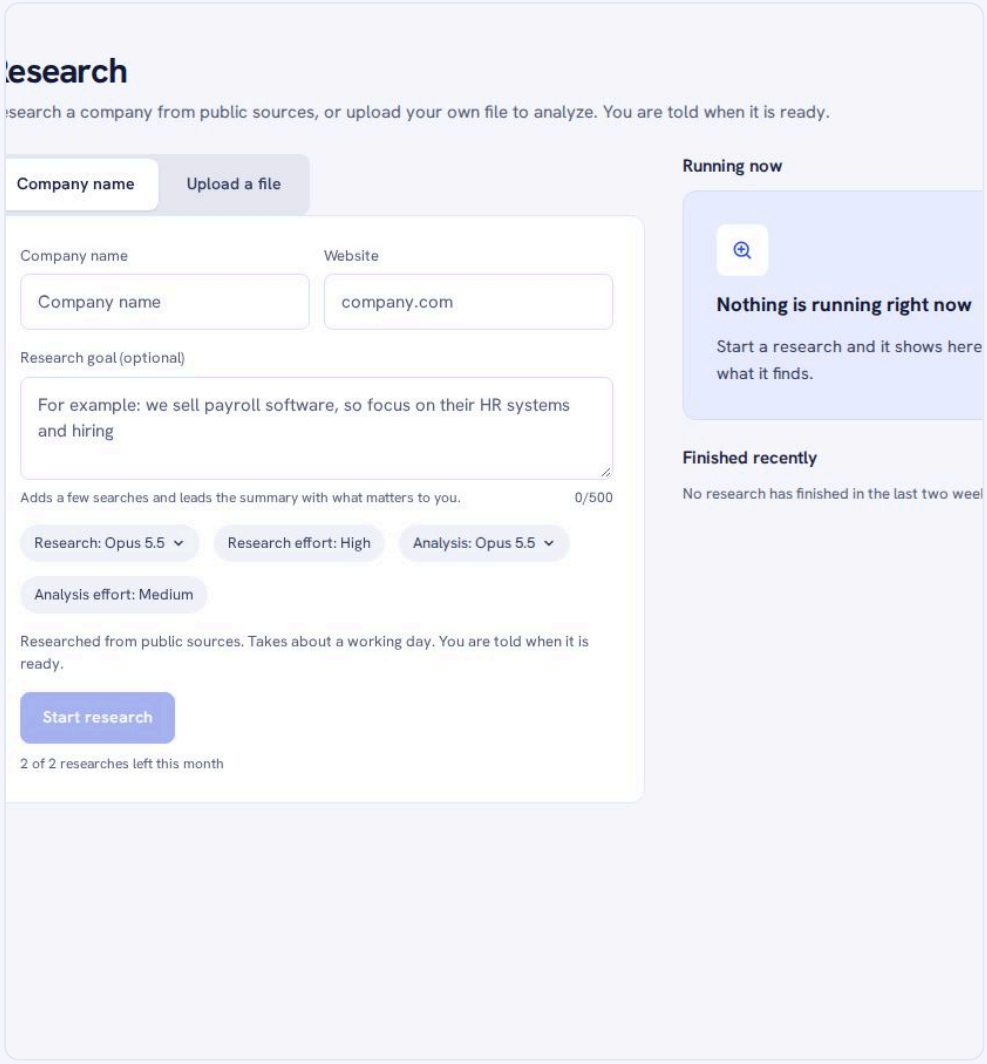


Before

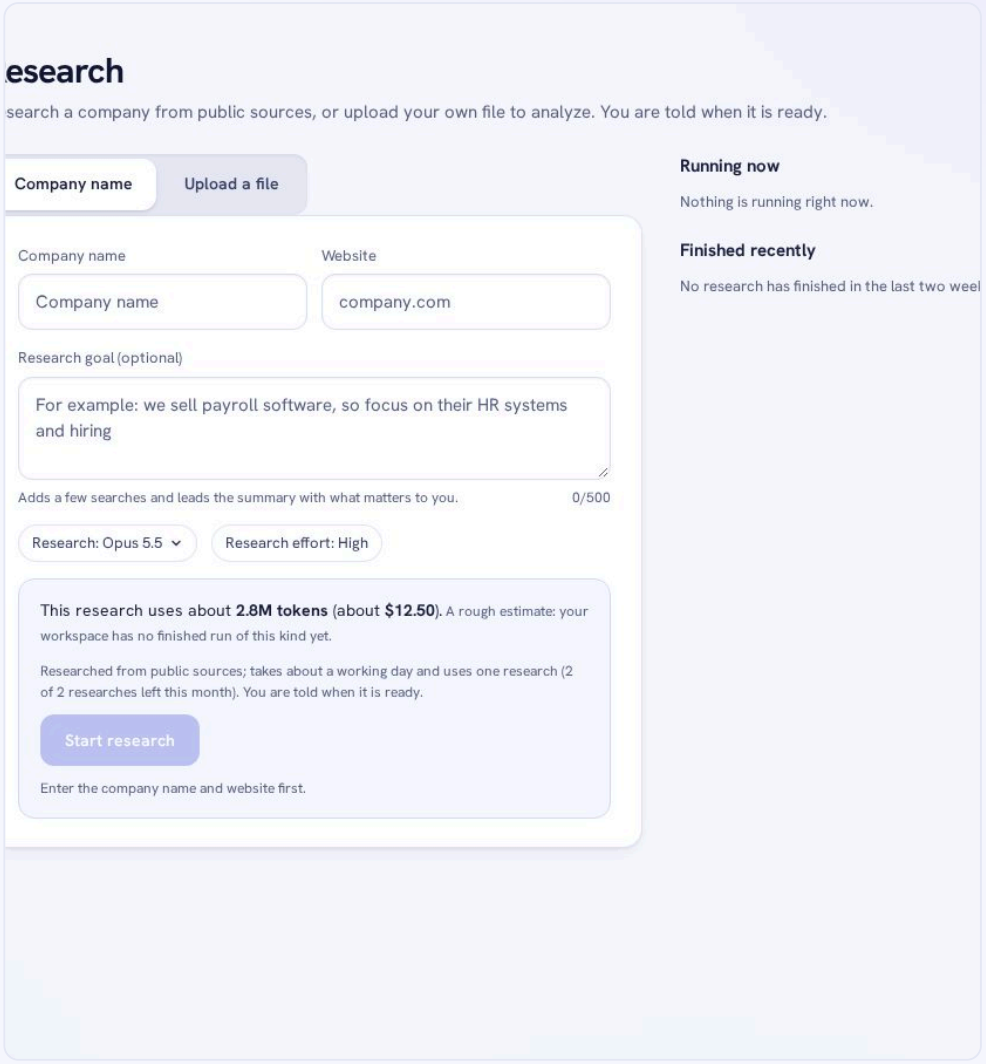


After

Before and after: Research



Before



After

Pop-ups, menus and buttons (1 of 2)

Every pop-up is now one shared, accessible dialog; menus close the way people expect; every button shows when it is working.

What the user saw	Cause	Now	
Pressing Escape, the backdrop or × while a refresh was being sent closed the pop-up; its error was never seen.	The pop-up did not know a start was in flight.	The pop-up cannot close while a start is being sent; a started refresh says so in a note and opens the Overview.	Fixed
Escape in the model menu closed the whole Refresh pop-up and lost the typed topic.	Both listened to Escape on the page and neither checked the other.	Escape closes only the open menu first; a second Escape closes the pop-up.	Fixed
Model and effort could be changed while "Are you sure?" showed, and the cost shown did not change.	The confirm step kept its state when the form changed.	Any change to the form disarms the confirm; the cost shown is always the picked option's.	Fixed
Delete account had no Escape, focus stayed behind it, the page scrolled, and the … menu stayed open after "Keep it".	A hand-made panel without focus handling.	Shared dialog: focus moves to the domain box, Tab stays inside, Escape and Keep it close it, focus returns, the menu closes.	Fixed
Focus could leave the Refresh pop-up with Shift+Tab, and the page behind could be scrolled and tabbed into.	Focus started on the panel; the page behind was not made inert.	Focus starts on the first control and is kept inside; the page behind is inert and does not scroll.	Fixed
The account's More and … menus never closed after a choice, an outside click or Escape, and both could be open at once.	Plain <details> elements with no script.	They close on a choice, a page change, an outside click and Escape; only one is open at a time.	Fixed
On a More page (Archive, Coverage …) no tab looked open.	Only the eight main tabs knew the address.	More shows the open page's name, underlined like a tab.	Fixed
At phone width the More menu opened off the left edge.	The menu was pinned to the right edge of a left-aligned button.	Pinned to the left on phones.	Fixed

Pop-ups, menus and buttons (2 of 2)

Every pop-up is now one shared, accessible dialog; menus close the way people expect; every button shows when it is working.

What the user saw	Cause	Now	
Rotating a tablet with the phone menu open left the page frozen with no way to close the menu.	The menu only closed on its own buttons, which hide at that width.	The menu closes when the page changes or the window widens.	Fixed
Switching Research tabs emptied the uploaded files and lost typed text.	The other tab was unmounted.	A tab stays mounted (hidden) once opened.	Fixed
"Download files" in the account header repeated the Files tab.	Two ways to the same place.	Removed; Files is a tab.	Removed
The research and refresh forms showed four model chips (Research, Research effort, Analysis, Analysis effort).	Every default exposed on every form.	Two chips: the research model and its effort. The analysis model comes from Settings > Models.	Removed
"Start research" stayed grey with no reason when the website was wrong.	Only an aria-invalid flag, no text.	"Enter the website as company.com." under the box, and the reason under the disabled button.	Fixed
Some buttons and menu items were 24–36 px tall.	Older one-off styles.	At least 36–40 px; the close button is 40 px.	Fixed
A click on a link or tab showed nothing for up to 10 s on slow pages.	No loading boundary under the account and Settings frames; no click feedback.	A glowing bar across the top, the clicked tab or link shows it is opening, and the tab body shows placeholders at once.	Fixed

Spending money: the confirm steps

The owner's rule is kept: two confirmations before any paid start, and the server still refuses a start without both.

What the user saw	Cause	Now	
Three presses on three different screens of text: Confirm refresh, then Proceed?, then Are you sure?	Each question replaced the one before.	The cost is shown up front; the first press arms the button (it glows and asks "Are you sure?"); the second starts.	Fixed
"Confirm refresh" confirmed nothing; it only opened the next question.	Label written for the old flow.	The button says what it does: Refresh, Research this topic, Start research, Analyze file.	Fixed
"Fix it first" in the confirm left the form and lost what was typed.	The link opened in the same tab.	Opens in a new tab.	Fixed
A successful refresh closed the pop-up with no confirmation at all.	No feedback after the start.	"Refresh started. You will be notified when it finishes." and the Overview with its progress.	Fixed

Refresh and live updates (1 of 2)

Screens now update when something actually changed, stop when the tab is hidden, and never die after one failed check.

What the user saw	Cause	Now	
One failed background check replaced the whole page (or the whole app) with an error and stopped all live updates.	The layout threw on any /v1/me failure; failed pages unmounted the pollers.	Only a signed-out session leaves the page; failed sections show Try again and keep retrying (15 s, 30 s, 60 s).	Fixed
A queued or credit-waiting research reloaded the whole page every 10 s, for days.	A timer refreshed the full page.	A light status read every 10 s (60 s while waiting for credit); the page redraws only when the status changes.	Fixed
Reading a zip redrew the whole page every 4 s.	Every counter change counted as a change.	Redraws only when a file's stage changes.	Fixed
An import longer than 15 minutes froze at "Indexing" until reload.	The give-up window never restarted.	The window restarts on every change and when the tab is shown again.	Fixed
Overview counts and findings stayed frozen during a whole research.	Only the progress card was polled.	The page redraws when a step finishes (at most every 30 s).	Fixed
File analysis reloaded the page every 5 s forever when waiting for approval or stalled.	"Done" excluded those states.	A small read with back-off (5 s to 30 s); stops on done, approval, failure; plain cards for each.	Fixed
Everything kept polling in hidden tabs; the run page fetched its spend twice every 5 s.	No visibility check; an object in the effect's dependencies.	All live reads pause while the tab is hidden and catch up when shown; the duplicate read is gone.	Fixed
Requests piled up on a slow API; a missing run polled forever; sign-out did not stop polling.	Fixed-interval timers with no in-flight guard.	Each read waits for the last; back-off to 30 s; 401 and 404 stop it.	Fixed

Refresh and live updates (2 of 2)

Screens now update when something actually changed, stop when the tab is hidden, and never die after one failed check.

What the user saw	Cause	Now	
One failed poll replaced the run's steps, Stop and Continue with an error.	Error took priority over loaded data.	Last data stays with a small "Reconnecting…" line.	Fixed
Viewers got an extra full reload on every account visit.	Their 403 on the uploads list counted as a failure.	403 means no uploads.	Fixed
File statuses froze while another file uploaded.	The status timer was reset by every progress event.	One steady timer; and leaving the page during an upload asks first.	Fixed
Run page: "You can leave this page" beside "not found"; a stopped run said "Finished"; a manual Refresh on a live page.	Texts written for the happy path.	Texts match the run's real state; the manual Refresh and the duplicate counts are gone.	Fixed

Errors, words and clutter (1 of 2)

Errors are short plain sentences with a way to try again; internal names and repeated text are gone.

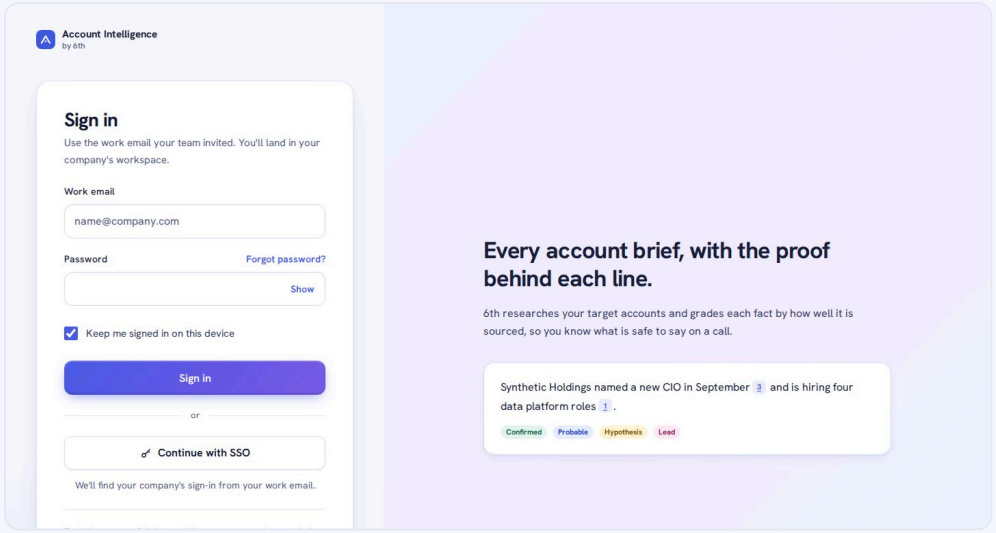
What the user saw	Cause	Now	
"Internal Server Error", "Unprocessable Content", "invalid request", a contract-mismatch line, or a blank alert in forms.	The API's status text was printed as the message.	One helper shows the API's own sentence only when it wrote one; otherwise a plain line for that action.	Fixed
The error page's Reload did nothing for server errors.	reset() redrew the cached output.	Reload fetches again (Next's retry).	Fixed
Table pages showed database table names and raw tool codes such as p_search:web_search.	Server text written for engineers.	Plain scope lines; tools read "Web search", "Page read"; arguments read as words.	Fixed
Three download buttons on each table page and a "Click a column heading to sort" hint.	Every format offered everywhere.	Two: the delivered file and the table as Excel.	Removed
The sign-in workspace picker showed a long internal id and a role code.	The API sends no name.	"Workspace 91ac (Analyst)"; real names need the API to send them.	Fixed
Email verification said to use "Security settings", which does not exist.	Stale text.	Points to the sign-in page's Send a new link, or the administrator.	Fixed
Deletes used the browser's own grey confirm box, and removing a paused upload deleted it without asking.	window.confirm and no check.	The shared confirm dialog, a plain error if it fails, and a short note when done.	Fixed
Non-admins saw Team and Support access tabs that only said "Only your administrator...".	Tabs not filtered by role.	Shown to admins only.	Fixed

Errors, words and clutter (2 of 2)

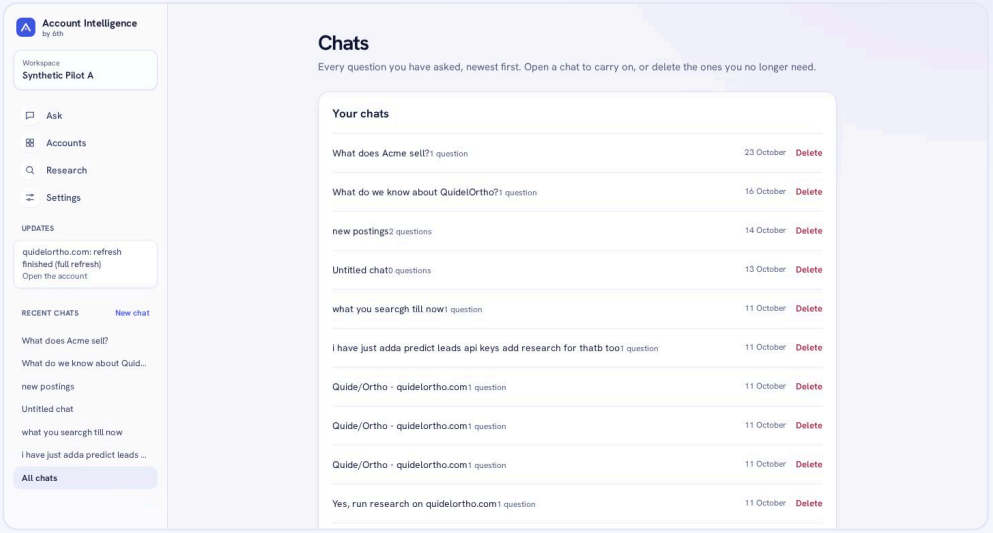
Errors are short plain sentences with a way to try again; internal names and repeated text are gone.

What the user saw	Cause	Now	
Overview: "Web: not used for answers", two help sentences, a 0 mail-and-drive row, a manual Refresh and two links to the same run.	Text added over time.	Removed; one link to the run.	Removed
The Research board showed Resume twice and an empty-state card beside the start form.	Two buttons with separate request keys.	One Resume in the detail panel; one quiet line when nothing runs.	Removed
Settings: "Used by…" lines and repeated intros.	Text repeated by the controls.	Trimmed.	Removed
Mail and drive Disconnect and Support access Revoke still use the browser confirm box.	Not in this round.	Works; to move to the shared dialog next.	Open
The per-answer token line, context ring, token card and the More audit tables (Calls made, Searches run, Notes).	Owner designs and client deliverables.	Kept as they are.	Kept

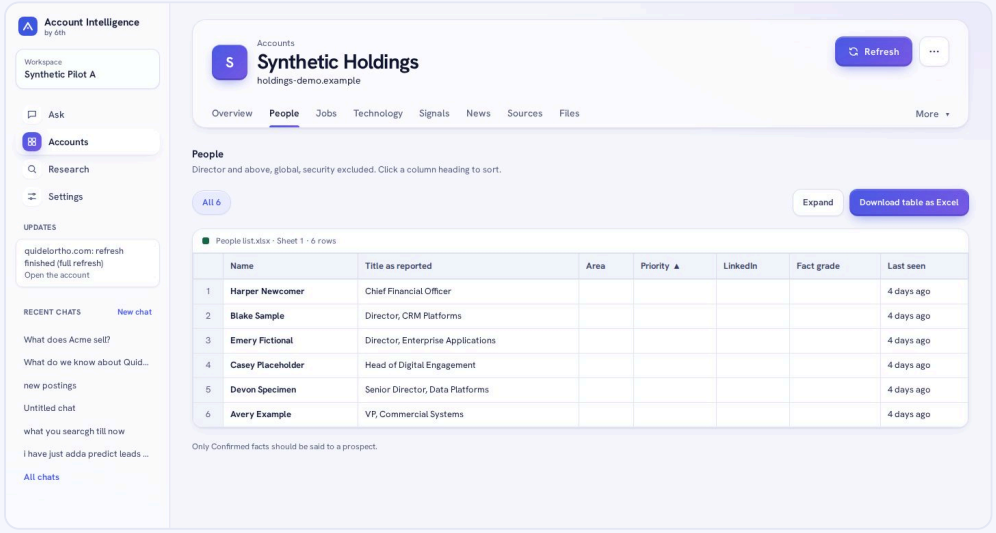
Every screen, desktop (1)



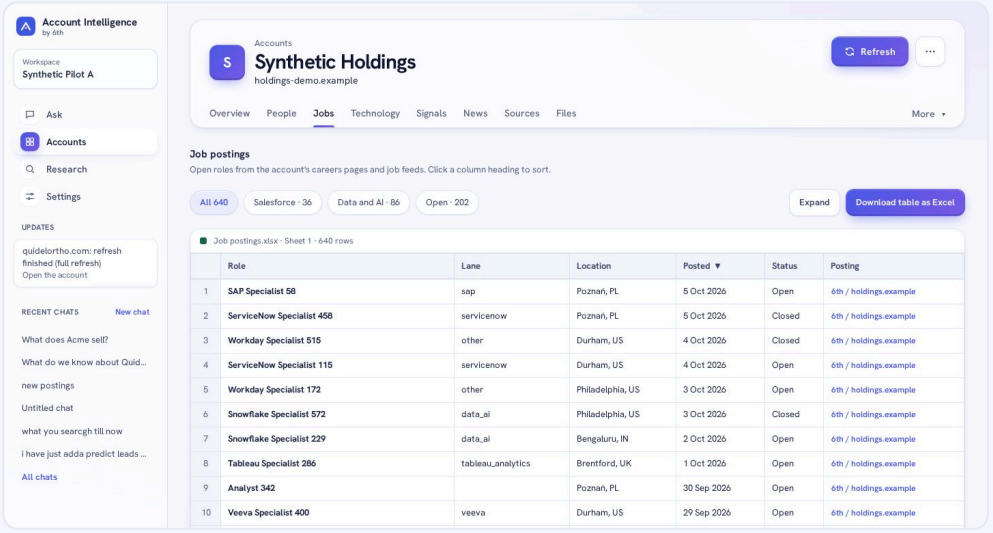
signin



chats

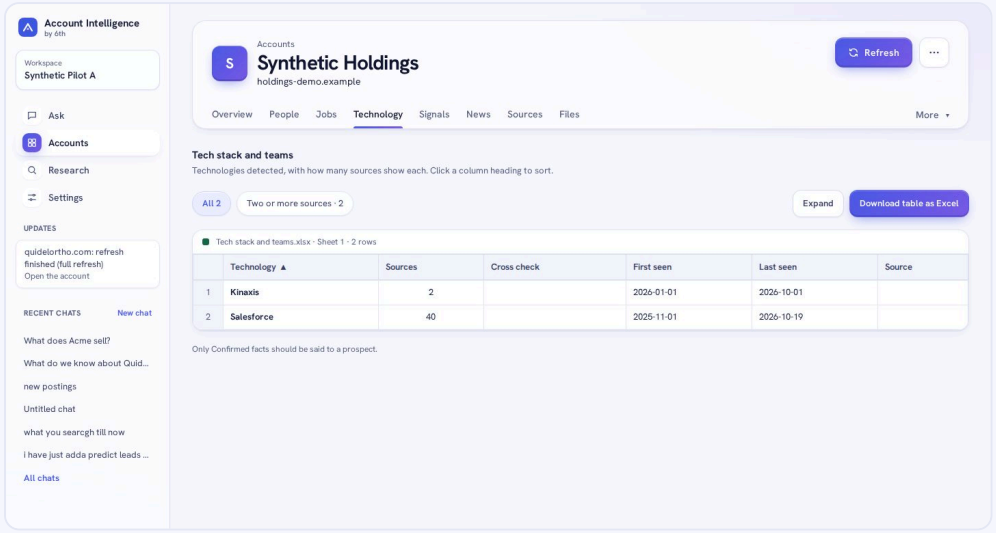


people

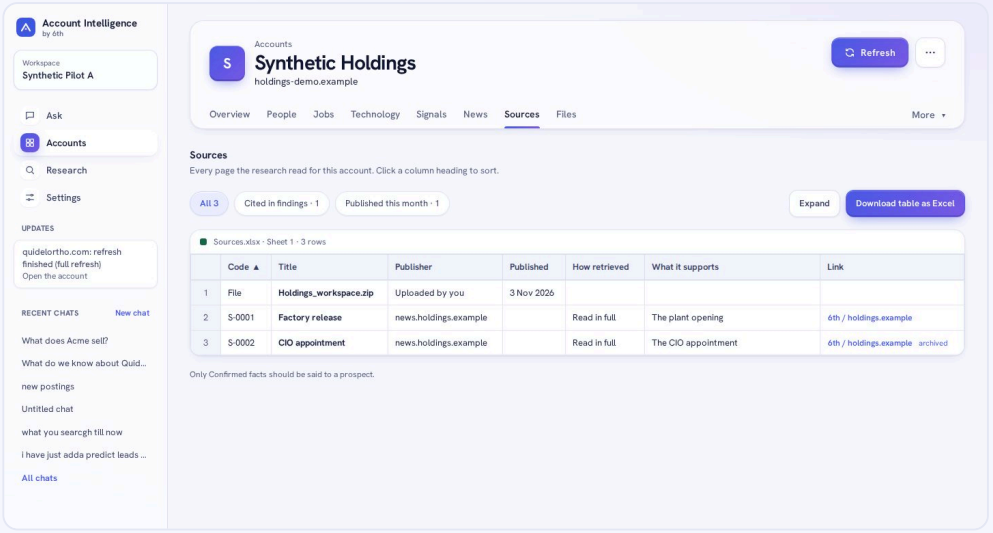


jobs

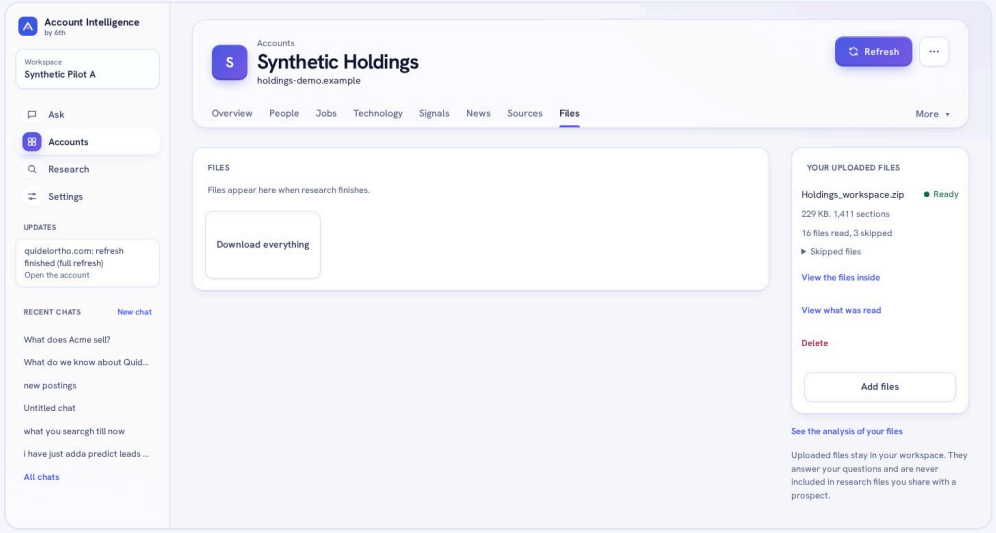
Every screen, desktop (2)



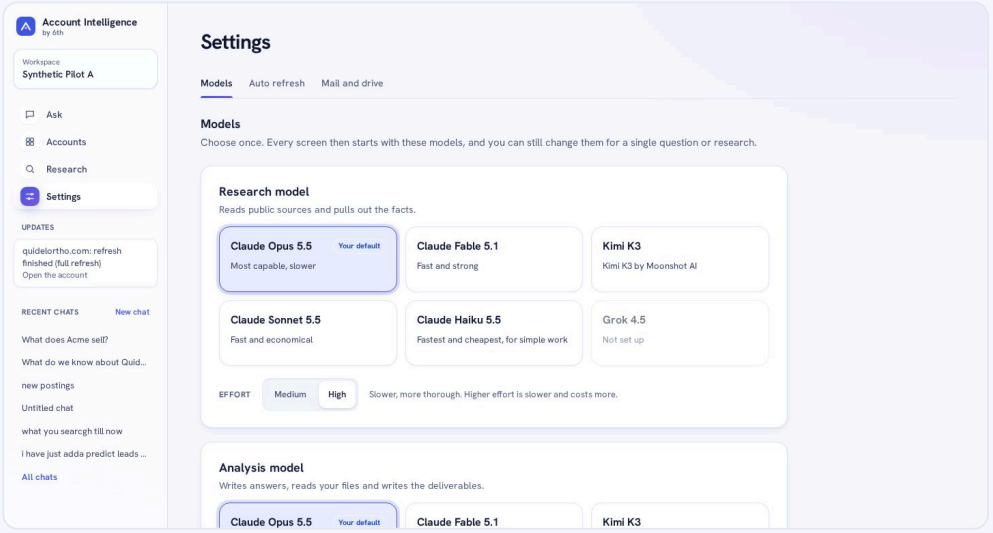
technology



sources

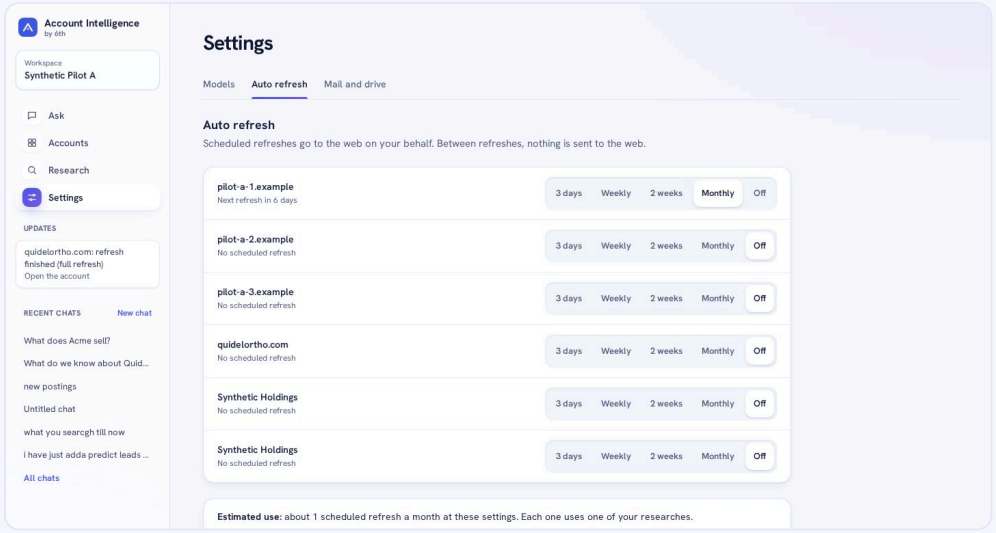


files

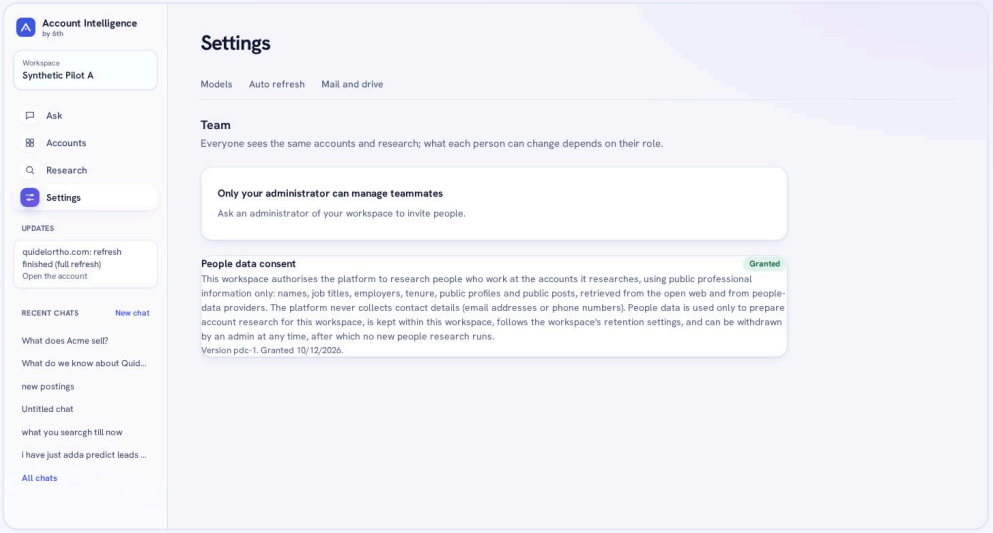


settings

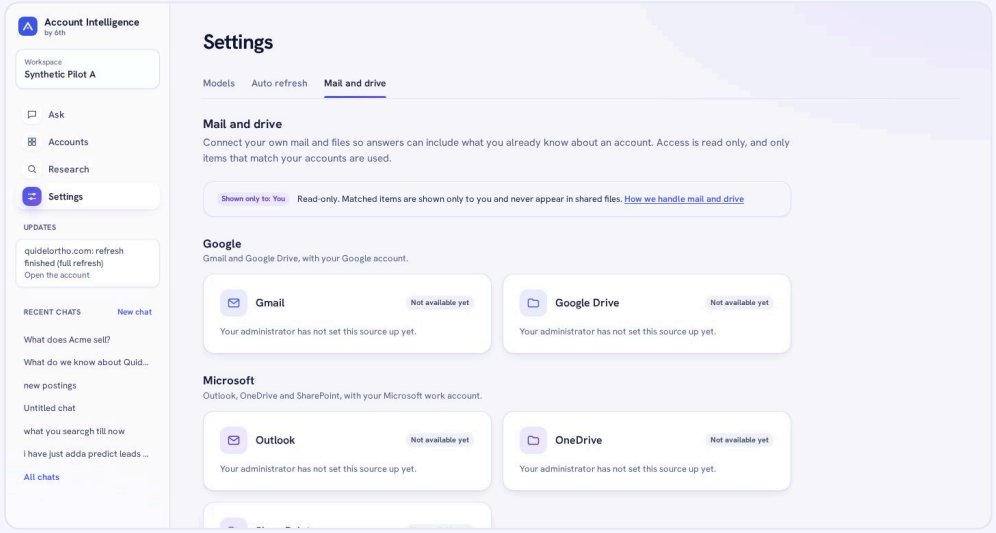
Every screen, desktop (3)



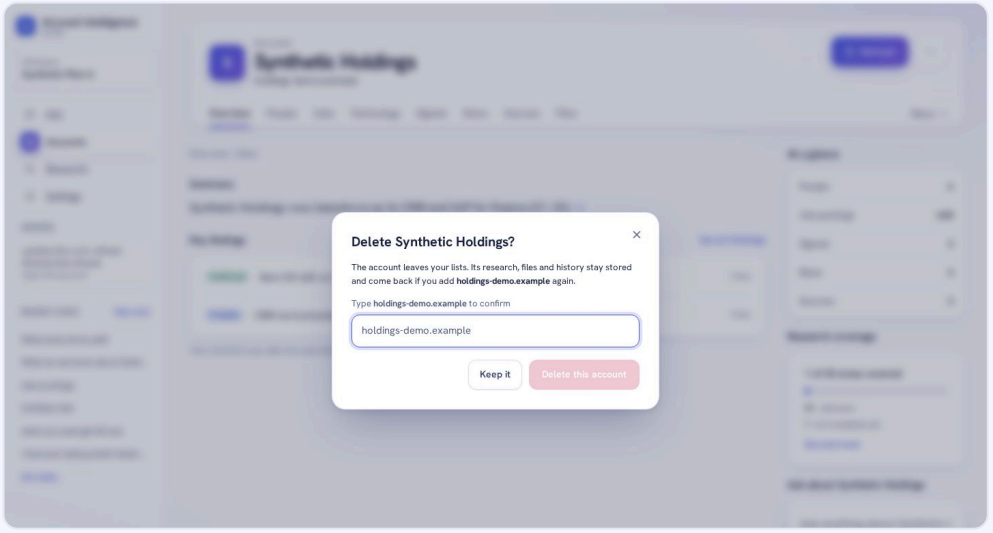
auto refresh



team

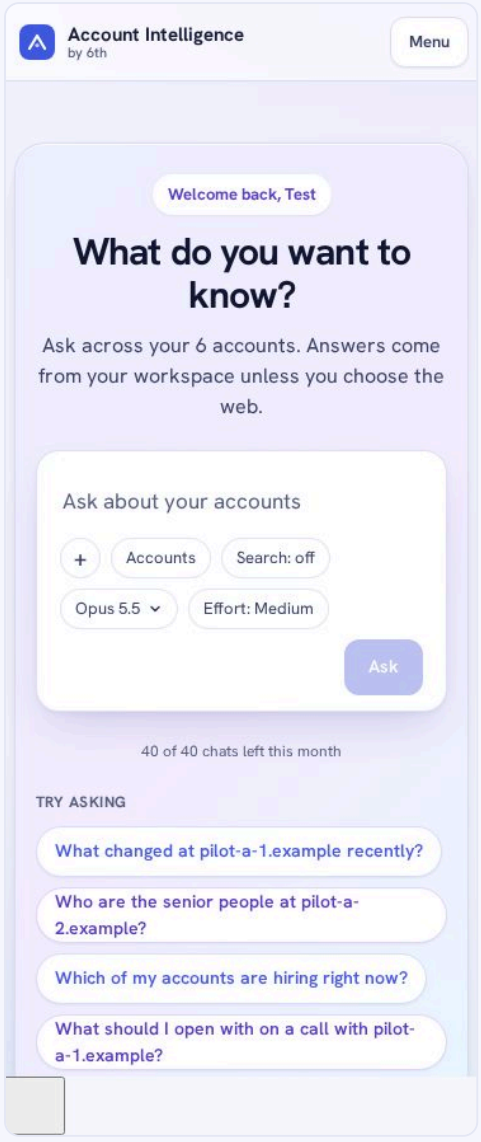


mail drive

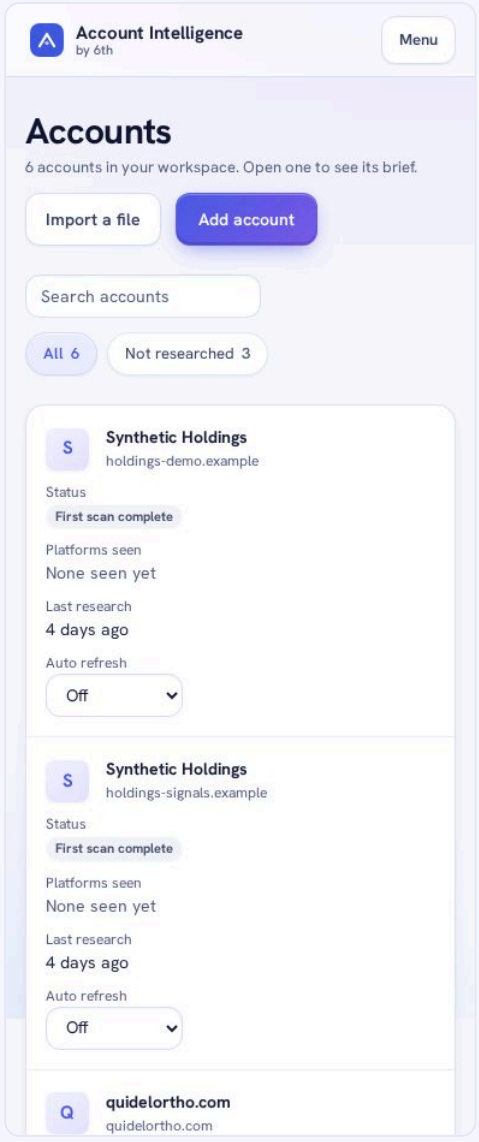


popup delete

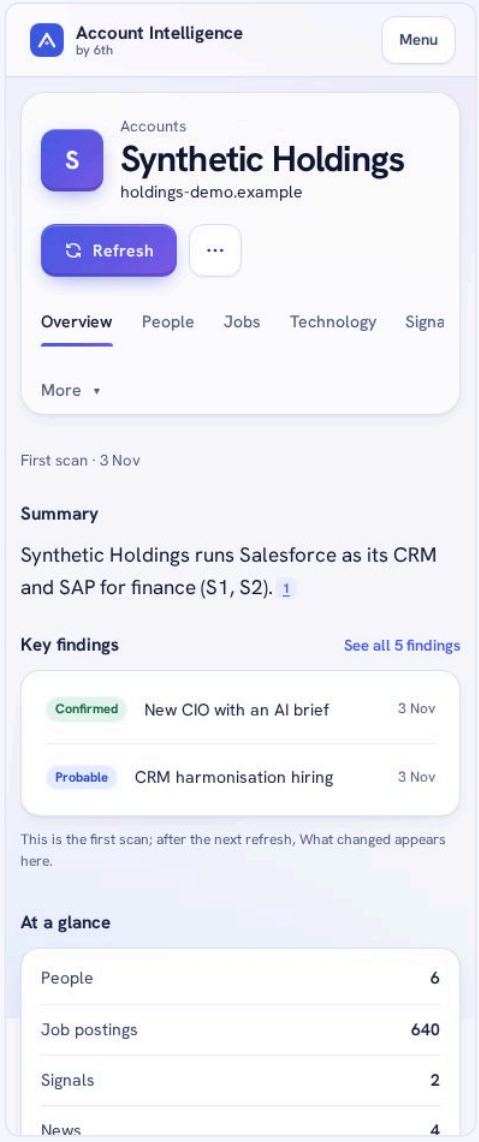
Phone width (390 px)



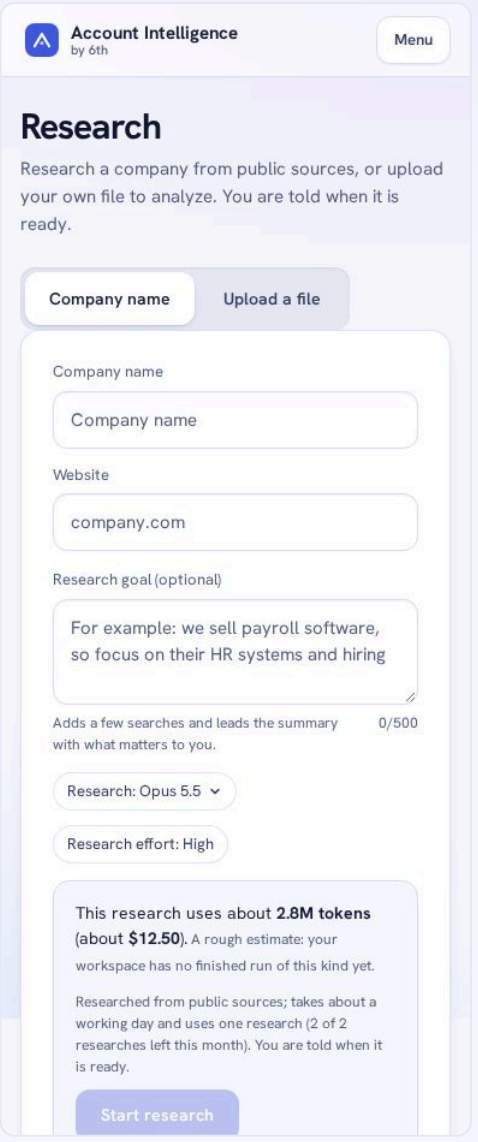
ask



accounts



account



research

Left for later, and a prompt to continue

- **Admin console.** Not touched, as asked. It keeps its current look until you want it redesigned.
- **Workspace names on sign-in.** The sign-in picker now shows "Workspace 1a2b" and the role in words; real names need the API to send them.
- **Kept on purpose.** The per-answer token line, the context ring and the token card are the owner's designs. The More tables (Calls made, Searches run, Notes) stay because clients receive them in their files.

Prompt to paste when you want the next round

```
Redesign the operator (admin) console in web/app/operator/** to match the client app's pastel 3D look.
- Reuse web/ui/depth.css: add the class "ui-pastel" to the operator shell root (app/operator/(console)/AdminShell.tsx) and the operator sign-in AuthFrame, then fix anything that looks wrong there.
- Use the shared pop-up web/ui/Modal.tsx (and ConfirmDialog) instead of the Radix dialogs, NavProgress for click feedback, and announce() from web/ui/Toaster.tsx after actions.
- Keep every operator feature and the owner's money rules (confirm twice before any paid start).
- Show me one screen first (Clients) as a screenshot before changing the rest.
- Then audit the console the same way as the client app: refresh/polling, pop-ups, buttons, error text, clutter; fix, run tsc, eslint and vitest, and add the screens to the PDF report in docs/ui-audit/2026-11-07-pastel.
```